

CURRENT AFFAIRS

DAILY DIGEST

10 SEPTEMBER 2026

POLITY & GOVERNANCE

Institutions • Rights • Reforms

ECONOMY

Growth • Markets • Financial Stability

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

India's partnerships • Global developments

ENVIRONMENT

Climate resilience • Sustainability

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Innovation • Research • Emerging technology

AGRICULTURE

Food security • Farmers • Rural development

NEW SEED LAW

INDIA MOVES TO CRACK DOWN ON FAKE & SUBSTANDARD SEEDS

Stronger laws for quality seeds, farmer protection and a more resilient agriculture sector.

BETTER
SEEDS
BRIGHTER
TOMORROWS



WHAT IS HAPPENING?

- Government is preparing a new **Seed Act**.
- Union Agriculture Minister is holding a nationwide consultation with major farmer organisations on **10 September 2026** at Krishi Bhawan before the legislation is finalised.
- Farmer experiences and suggestions will inform the draft.



WHY A NEW FRAMEWORK?

- Fake or poor-quality seed can cause **crop failure** and heavy income loss for farmers.
- Traceability and enforcement gaps weaken farmer protection.
- Reliable seed quality supports higher productivity and food security.



CORE IDEAS



Stringent action against fake, adulterated and substandard seeds.



Stronger seed-quality standards.



End-to-end traceability from production to sale.



Accountability of companies and traders.



Protection of farmers' traditional-seed rights.



SEED GOVERNANCE BASICS

- Regulation covers quality standards, labelling, sale and enforcement.
- Central and state institutions share implementation responsibilities.
- Plant-variety protection and farmers' rights are related but distinct from seed-quality regulation.



PRELIMS FACTS

- **Seeds Act, 1966** is a key existing seed-quality law.
- **Seeds (Control) Order, 1983** regulates seed dealers under the Essential Commodities framework.
- **Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Act, 2001** covers breeders' and farmers' rights.



AGRICULTURE LINK

- Quality seed is a foundational farm input.
- Genetic purity, germination, physical purity and seed health influence crop performance.
- Traceability can help quickly identify defective seed lots and prevent wider losses.

QUALITY
SEEDS
STRONGER
HARVESTS



MAINS ANGLE

Reform must balance farmer protection, innovation and investment, affordable access, biodiversity, traditional seed systems, testing capacity and enforceable accountability.



WATCH NEXT

- Draft bill text.
- Treatment of farmer-saved / traditional seed.
- Certification and registration rules.
- Penalties for violations.
- Traceability requirements.
- Parliamentary process.



QUALITY SEED



PRODUCTIVITY



FARM INCOME



FOOD SECURITY

MARITAL RAPE EXCEPTION — SUPREME COURT TO TEST CONSTITUTIONAL VALIDITY

Marriage does not extinguish individual autonomy:
Supreme Court to examine challenges to the marital rape exception.

WHAT HAPPENED?

- Supreme Court will **begin final hearing after about three weeks** on petitions challenging the marital rape exception.
- Challenges concern the exception under IPC and now under the BNS.
- Court will test whether the exception survives constitutional scrutiny.

WHAT DOES CURRENT LAW SAY?

- **Exception 2 to Section 63 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS)** excludes sexual acts by a man with his own wife from the offence of rape.
- The wife must **not be under 18 years** of age for the exception to apply.
- BNS replaced the IPC from **1 July 2024**.

COURT'S DILEMMA

- Court observed that individual **autonomy** continues within marriage.
- But can courts permit rape prosecution while Parliament has expressly retained an exception?
- The Court says the constitutionality of the exception must be examined.



"Marriage does not extinguish individual autonomy."

SUPREME COURT

PRELIMS FACTS

- **Section 63 BNS** defines rape and contains the marital exception.
- **Article 14** guarantees equality before law and equal protection.
- **Article 20(1)** protects against ex-post-facto criminal liability.
- **Article 21** protects life and personal liberty.



CORE CONSTITUTIONAL QUESTIONS

- Article 14** Equality before law and protection against arbitrariness.
- Article 21** Right to life, dignity, privacy and bodily autonomy.
- Article 20(1)** No conviction for an act that was not an offence under the law in force when committed.
- Separation of powers** Limits of judicial interpretation versus Parliament's law-making role.

IMPORTANT BACKGROUND

- Delhi High Court delivered a **split verdict** in 2022 on the marital rape exception.
- Karnataka High Court allowed prosecution of a husband in a case that is now before the Supreme Court.
- Supreme Court's 2017 **Independent Thought** judgment protected minor wives by reading the age threshold consistently with 18 years.

MAINS ANGLE

- Consent and bodily autonomy within marriage.
- Equality and protection from sexual violence.
- Misuse concerns and due-process safeguards.
- Institutional competence: judicial adjudication or legislative reform.

WATCH NEXT

- Final hearing before the Supreme Court.
- How the Court treats Section 63 exception.
- Outcome in the Karnataka appeal.
- Centre's arguments that criminalisation is for Parliament.
- Whether the Court strikes down, reads down or upholds the provision.

BRICS SUMMIT 2026

INDIA'S MULTILATERALISM & GLOBAL SOUTH AGENDA

12 – 13 SEPTEMBER 2026 | NEW DELHI, INDIA

10 SEPT 2026

LATEST
DEVELOPMENT

STRONGER
PARTNERSHIPS
A BRIGHTER,
MORE INCLUSIVE
WORLD

NEW DELHI
HOSTS
A STRONGER
GLOBAL SOUTH

DIALOGUE
DEVELOPMENT
A FAIRER WORLD

WHAT IS HAPPENING?



- India hosts the **18th BRICS Summit** in New Delhi on **12–13 September 2026**.
- Leaders will focus on **“Inclusive Global Governance and Strengthening Multilateralism”** in the opening closed session.

INDIA'S PRIORITIES



- Resilient supply chains
- Startups and innovation
- Green energy and sustainable development
- Practical cooperation for the Global South
- Reform of international institutions

WHAT IS BRICS?



- An intergovernmental/plurilateral grouping of major emerging economies.
- Decisions are **consensus-based**.
- Chairship rotates among members.
- Cooperation spans political-security, economic-financial and people-to-people areas.

WHY MULTILATERAL REFORM?



- Emerging economies seek a greater voice in institutions created under older global power structures.
- Key issues:** fairer representation, development finance and stronger responses to cross-border challenges like climate change, pandemics and food-energy security.

FINANCIAL COOPERATION



- Discussions include cross-border payments and greater use of national currencies in trade and settlements.
- Not the same as an imminent single BRICS currency.**
- Aim is to reduce transaction costs and enhance financial resilience.

NEW DEVELOPMENT BANK (NDB)



- Created by BRICS members in 2014 through the Fortaleza process.
- Headquartered in Shanghai, China.
- Finances infrastructure and sustainable-development projects in member and other developing countries.

INDIA'S BALANCING ROLE



- India supports a multipolar, reformed international order.
- Emphasis on strategic autonomy, consensus and practical development cooperation rather than bloc confrontation.

PRELIMS FACTS



- BRICS began with Brazil, Russia, India and China; South Africa joined later.
- NDB was established through the Fortaleza process in 2014.
- BRICS has no permanent secretariat like the UN.

MAINS ANGLE



BRICS gives India a platform to advance Global South priorities, institutional reform and development cooperation, but internal geopolitical differences and differing economic interests can limit collective action.

WATCH NEXT



- New Delhi summit declaration
- Language on UN/IMF reform
- Progress on payment systems and national currencies
- Supply-chain initiatives
- Green-energy cooperation
- Possibility of future expansion

A MORE
INCLUSIVE
TOMORROW

STRATEGIC AUTONOMY • MULTIPOLARITY • GLOBAL SOUTH • REFORMED MULTILATERALISM

AI BOOM & FINANCIAL STABILITY BIS FLAGS NEW RISKS

HUGE OPPORTUNITIES. REAL RISKS. A MORE COMPLEX GLOBAL ECONOMY.



WHAT HAPPENED?

- BIS head Pablo Hernández de Cos warns that the **AI investment boom** creates new financial-stability risks.
- Remarks made at an RBI-hosted conference in India.
- AI can boost productivity but may also amplify financial vulnerabilities.

SCALE OF THE BOOM

Top five global tech firms:

> \$1 trillion

AI infrastructure investment estimated for 2025–26.

Broader global AI investment could approach

\$4 trillion by 2030.



WHY CENTRAL BANKS CARE

- AI simultaneously changes aggregate demand, productive capacity, labour markets, asset valuations and financing conditions.
- This makes inflation, growth and financial-risk assessment harder.



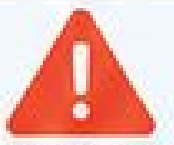
A MORE
INTERCONNECTED
AND COMPLEX
ECONOMY

FINANCIAL-STABILITY CHANNEL

- Large capital expenditure on AI infrastructure.
- Greater debt and private-credit financing.
- Opaque exposures can make leverage and risk concentration harder to monitor.
- Rapid asset-price expectations can reverse if returns disappoint.



DEBT &
PRIVATE CREDIT



HIGHER
LEVERAGE RISK

PRODUCTIVITY UPSIDE

- Generative AI can improve productivity in specific tasks such as coding and professional writing.
- Economy-wide gains depend on diffusion, complementary infrastructure, skills, competition and movement of workers/capital to productive uses.



HUMAN SKILLS
+ AI
HIGHER
PRODUCTIVITY

INDIA ANGLE

- India's digital public infrastructure and technology workforce create opportunities.
- Priorities include AI skills, compute and energy infrastructure, responsible finance, competition and worker transition.



SKILLS
INFRASTRUCTURE
INCLUSIVE GROWTH

PRELIMS FACTS

- BIS is an international organisation serving central banks and is headquartered in Basel, Switzerland.
- **Financial stability** means the financial system can perform core functions and absorb shocks.
- **Private credit** refers broadly to lending outside traditional public bond markets and often outside conventional bank lending channels.

MAINS ANGLE

- Policymakers must capture AI-driven productivity while guarding against leverage, concentration, labour displacement and unequal access. Innovation policy and macro-financial regulation need to evolve together.

WATCH NEXT

- AI investment financing
- Private-credit exposure
- Productivity data
- Labour-market effects
- Semiconductor supply chains
- Central-bank financial-stability assessments



AI PRODUCTIVITY + SOUND FINANCE + SKILLS = RESILIENT GROWTH



10 SEPT 2026

ASEAN-INDIA

AGRICULTURE PLAN 2026-2030

FOOD SECURITY, CLIMATE RESILIENCE & DIGITAL FARMING

Deepening cooperation for sustainable, resilient and inclusive agriculture across South and Southeast Asia

STRONGER FARMS
STRONGER REGION
BRIGHTER TOMORROW

PEOPLE
CROPS
PLANET
PROSPERITY
TOGETHER

SHARED SOLUTIONS
FOR A FOOD-SECURE AND RESILIENT TOMORROW



WHAT HAPPENED?

9th ASEAN-India Ministerial Meeting on Agriculture and Forestry held in New Delhi.

India and ASEAN backed stronger farmer-centred cooperation for 2026-2030.



CORE PRIORITIES (2026-2030)



Climate-resilient farming



Sustainable and low-emission agriculture (including rice systems)



Digital and AI-enabled agriculture



Joint research and innovation



Capacity building and farmer exchanges



Resilient food and agricultural supply chains



WHY IT MATTERS

- South and Southeast Asia face climate shocks, food-price volatility, pests, water stress and supply-chain disruption.
- Regional cooperation can share technology, germplasm, research and good practices.



RESILIENT
FARMS
STRONGER
PEOPLE



INDIA-ASEAN FRAMEWORK

- Agriculture and forestry cooperation sits within the **ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership**.
- Ministers welcomed **ASEAN 2045: Our Shared Future** and the **ASEAN Food, Agriculture and Forestry Sectoral Plan 2026-2030**.



A STRONGER
AND MORE PROSPEROUS
INDO-PACIFIC



GENE RESOURCES

- NBPGR is India's nodal institution for management of plant genetic resources.
- Germplasm conservation supports crop breeding, biodiversity and climate resilience.



CONSERVING
DIVERSITY
FOR A RESILIENT FUTURE



LOW-EMISSION RICE

- Rice cultivation can emit methane under flooded conditions.
- Improved water and crop-management practices can reduce emissions while maintaining productivity.



CLIMATE-SMART RICE
FOR A GREENER TOMORROW



PRELIMS FACTS

- ASEAN was established in 1967.
- Its Secretariat is in Jakarta.
- India is a dialogue partner, not an ASEAN member.
- ICAR is India's apex agricultural research body.
- NBPGR works on plant genetic resources.



MAINS ANGLE

Agricultural diplomacy can connect food security, climate adaptation, biodiversity, technology sharing and Global South cooperation, but implementation requires financing, farmer access and locally suitable technologies.



WATCH NEXT

- Projects under the 2026-2030 plan
- AI/digital agriculture cooperation
- Low-emission rice initiatives
- Germplasm and research exchanges
- Resilient regional food supply chains



FOOD SECURITY



CLIMATE RESILIENCE



INNOVATION



REGIONAL COOPERATION

THRIVING
FARMERS
STRONGER
TOMORROWS